

When the stock report looks acceptable, but confidence still needs checking

Opening stock, closing stock, purchases and sales were all available as separate reports.

At headline level, the movement almost reconciled: expected closing stock was 4.90M against an actual closing stock of 4.89M, leaving a relatively small difference to review.

The management question was not “who got this wrong?”

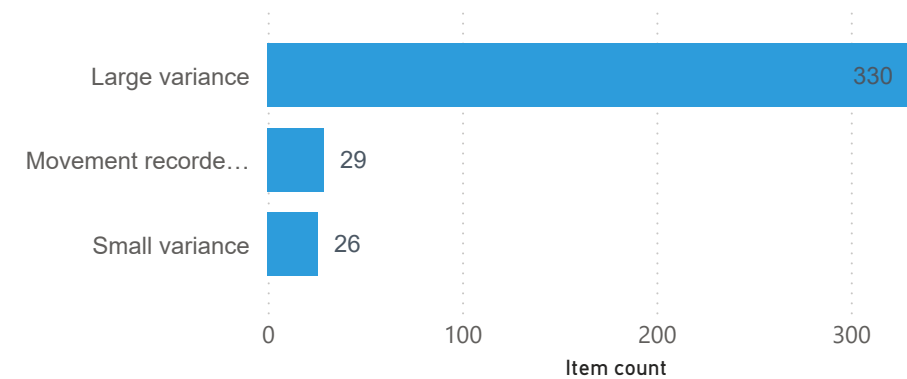
It was: which product/location checks already reconcile, which need review, and what assumptions are missing before the report can be trusted?

Summary of Stock Counts and Net Transactions Recorded

4.22M Opening stock quantity 2016	4.89M Closing stock quantity 2016	4.90M Expected Closing Stock	-2.88K Difference to Review
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Product/location checks needing review

2.76K product/location checks matched expected movement; 385 needed review



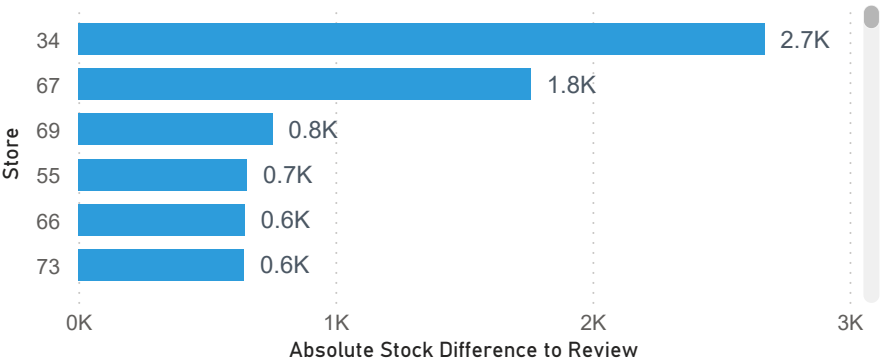
Turning a stock difference into a review plan

The review became more useful once exceptions were linked back to location.

City-level totals helped identify where the pattern appeared, but some cities contained more than one store. That meant store-level detail was needed before anyone could decide where to review process, timing, stock movements or system links.

This shifted the conversation from “there is a stock difference” to “where should the review start, and what evidence does that location need?”

Absolute Stock Difference to Review by Store



City/location Review Flag

City	Total Quantity to Review
PITMERDEN	2,670.00
34	2,670.00
EANVERNESS	2,503.00
67	1,760.00
66	648.00
4	95.00
DONCASTER	1,239.00
73	645.00
76	594.00
MOUNTMEND	1,048.00
69	756.00
27	168.00
32	124.00
DRY GULCH	657.00
GARIGILL	589.00
GOULCREST	511.00
HORNSEY	460.00
HARDERSFIELD	392.00
Total	17,132.00

What the Review Made Possible

The review did not lead to a single conclusion that the data was wrong. It showed where the business needed better-connected evidence.

Once matched records were separated from review items, the next step became practical: agree the transaction cut-offs, check whether adjustments and transfers are visible, and decide whether the current reporting process is enough or whether stronger system links are needed.

Finding	Risk	Practical next step
Most records reconciled	Confidence exists, but needs exception control	Keep matched records separate from review items
385 product/location checks needed review	Manual checking can become scattered	Create one exception report and review owner
Some movement was recorded without matching stock snapshot movement	Transactions and stock counts may not share the same timing or scope	Review cut-off rules, adjustment logs, transfers, and stock count timing
Differences concentrated by store/location	Review effort should not be spread equally	Prioritise high-variance stores first
Product/location and pack-size logic mattered	Quantities may be compared without enough context	Confirm product keys, size/volume fields, and units used in reports

The purpose is not to reduce confidence in the team. It is to give the team better-connected evidence so management can trust the numbers without relying on scattered manual checks.

Recommendations would depend on maturity and budget:

- 1. **Low-cost process control:** regular stock confidence checks, cut-off dates, shared adjustment log
- 2. **Connected reporting layer:** link stock counts, purchases, and sales in SQL/Power Query or Power BI
- 3. **System improvement:** ERP/WMS integration, consistent master data, controlled transaction types